

UWC International

CRM and Applications Platform Supplier Evaluation Technical Questions Briefing

1. Purpose

This document sets out some further technical and security topics that UWC International wishes to explore as part of the supplier evaluation. These topics complement the written responses already submitted.

Suppliers are asked to provide a written response to each of the topics set out in Section 3 and return this ahead of the demonstration and presentation session by Thursday 21st May.

2. Format

2.1 Written Response

Suppliers should prepare a written response addressing each topic below. Responses should be clear and concise, and should explain the platform's approach, describe relevant features or capabilities, and identify any areas where additional configuration or development would be required.

Written responses should be returned to procurement@uwcio.uwc.org by the deadline confirmed in the covering communication.

2.2 Follow-Up Discussion

The evaluation panel may ask follow-up questions on these topics during the demonstration and presentation session, typically during the Questions and Discussion slot or during the Implementation Approach and Delivery Plan presentation where relevant.

Suppliers should ensure that the appropriate technical personnel are present at the session and prepared to discuss these topics in further detail.

3. Technical Discussion Topics

3.1 Cybersecurity and Breach Response

Active Data Breach Detection and Containment

Context: A high-level administrative account has been compromised and an automated system detects an unusual bulk export of sensitive applicant data to an unrecognised IP address.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Real-time detection and alerting: How does the platform notify administrators of suspicious activity?
- Immediate containment: How are compromised accounts frozen and active sessions terminated?
- Forensic capability: What audit logs are available to identify exactly what data was accessed and exported?
- Incident communication: What is the platform's protocol for notifying the client under GDPR and applicable data privacy regulations?

Ransomware and Data Recovery

Context: UWC experiences a localised ransomware attack. While the platform is cloud-based, UWC International needs assurance that data remains uncorrupted and that business continuity is maintained.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Backup strategy: Frequency, isolation from the production environment, and immutability of backups
- Point-in-time recovery: The process for restoring the database to a specific pre-incident state
- Data integrity verification: How the system confirms that restored data is clean and uncorrupted

3.2 Data Loss Prevention and Leakage

Accidental Record Deletion and Recovery

Context: A staff member accidentally deletes 500 active student application records while attempting a bulk update.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Soft-delete or recycle bin functionality: Where deleted records are held and for how long
- Mass restoration: The steps to restore records with all associated history and attachments intact

Data Leakage Prevention

Context: A user attempts to download a report containing thousands of personal email addresses and phone numbers onto a personal device.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Download monitoring: Whether the system flags or blocks large-scale data downloads
- Network restrictions: Whether UWC can restrict system access to specific IP ranges or authorised networks

3.3 Document Encryption and Privacy

Protection of Sensitive Documents

Context: The application process involves the submission of high-risk personal documents in PDF format. These must be encrypted during upload and at rest, with strictly controlled access.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Encryption in transit: Protocols used to secure data between the applicant's browser and the platform (e.g. TLS 1.2+)
- Encryption at rest: Encryption standards applied to file storage (e.g. AES-256)
- Secure viewing: Whether documents are viewed via a secure in-browser viewer or require local download
- File access audit trail: Logging of every user who has viewed or accessed a specific sensitive document

3.4 API Security and Third-Party Integrations

Least-Privilege Integration Controls

Context: UWC International plans to connect third-party tools (such as marketing automation or analytics) to the platform. These integrations must be restricted to specific data points and must not access sensitive student files without explicit, granular permission.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Scoped API permissions: How API keys or OAuth tokens are restricted to read-only access for specific fields rather than the entire database
- Permission review: The interface for administrators to review exactly what data an external application is requesting before granting access
- Audit and revocation: Logging of API calls and the process for instantly revoking access for a specific integration

3.5 User Security and Authentication

Multi-Factor Authentication

Context: UWC International may require MFA for all staff accessing the platform, regardless of their location.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Native MFA enrolment: The process for users to set up MFA (e.g. authenticator app, security keys) within the platform
- Mandatory enforcement: How an administrator can globally enforce MFA for specific roles
- Account recovery: The protocol for assisting a user who has lost their MFA device without creating a security vulnerability

Role-Based Access Control

Context: An external admissions reviewer needs access to evaluate applications but must not see financial aid documents or be able to export contact lists.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Granular permissions: Creating a custom reviewer role with restricted visibility
- Field-level security: Hiding specific sensitive fields from specific user groups
- Export restrictions: Disabling the export function for certain roles whilst retaining view access

3.6 Language Accessibility and Multi-Language Support

Multi-Language Configuration and Translation Management

Context: The application form must be available in French, Spanish, and Arabic for applicants from NCs where these are the primary languages. NC Admins in those regions need to manage their own localised content without contacting IO for every change, whilst still collecting all required standard information.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Configuration of supported languages at platform and programme level
- NC Admin ability to add localised questions (e.g. in French) without requiring IO involvement
- Applicant experience in Arabic, including right-to-left (RTL) text rendering and layout
- Reviewer and NC Admin interface presented in languages other than English (e.g. Spanish)
- Updating or correcting a translation and managing language version consistency

3.7 Data Export, Reporting, GDPR Compliance, and Audit Trail

Compliance Reporting and Data Subject Rights

Context: An IO Super Admin needs to run a compliance audit, export a dataset of all nominated students for a specific admissions cycle, demonstrate the GDPR right-to-erasure process, and show a full audit trail of changes to a sensitive record.

Please address the following in your written response:

- Export of a filtered dataset scoped to a specific NC or admissions cycle
- A cross-NC report generated at IO level for compliance or operational oversight
- A full audit trail for a single record, showing all changes, access events, and timestamps
- Processing a GDPR right-to-erasure (right to be forgotten) request, including what data is removed and what is retained for legal obligations
- Data retention rules and any automation for managing retention periods

4. Contact

If you have any questions regarding this briefing, please contact:

procurement@uwcio.uwc.org

Please do not contact members of the evaluation panel directly.